comprised over 400 ocean-going ships of different types and names: *Kotia, Navadi, Machhava, Dhan, Tar* and *Hodi*.[69] Kotias were fast ships designed to resist strong winds and measured less than 150 feet in length. With the use of Kotias, Kachchh's tryst with Muscat grew in the 19th century under the Omani Sultanate and eventually extended its reach to Zanzibar in Africa. Merchant circulation between Kachchh, Muscat and Zanzibar was common as part of the trade of dates, pearls and ivory in the 19th century with counterparties based as far away as the US. The trading season would begin in the middle of September, when the south-west monsoon would fade, and end in May or June with the return of the monsoon. Apart from the Jains, Bhatias and Lohanas, Kachchh also hosted the Goswamis, worshippers of Shiva, with monasteries scattered across multiple locations. Remarkably, these monasteries also acted as banks and handled advanced financial instruments that supported the spirit of business and migration.

If Kachchhi mercantile migration was the highlight of Gujarati migration in the 19th century, Patidar migration from central Gujarat emerged as a major phenomenon in the 20th century. Patidars were traditionally rooted in agriculture and formed the dominant caste in many parts of Gujarat, usually carrying the surname Patel. Vallabhbhai Patel (1875–1950), independent India's first home minister, and arguably the most famous Patel, was a prominent migrant from central Gujarat who spent several years in London, Ahmedabad and Delhi. The Charotar Patidars of Kheda district began migrating to East Africa in the late 20th century to open shops and soon began pulling their brethren there as new opportunities were opened up by colonial investment.[70] They were associated with retail and wholesale trade, but they also came to dominate the ginning industry in Uganda, where they were heavily concentrated. By 1970, there were around 50,000 Patidars in East Africa, but nativist policies pursued by the decolonized African states led to many of them moving to the United Kingdom and North America. Thus began an extensive chain migration of Patidars from central Gujarat to the UK and North America in the late 20th century, often using links formed by the relocation from East Africa.[71] In the UK, the Patidars ran small stores and conducted trade around London and Leicester. The